

Congregation Bible Study — July 20-26, 2026

Congregation Bible Study — Week of July 20-26, 2026

Walk Courageously With God (*wcg*) — “A Letter From the Governing Body” and Introduction

8 comment options + 2 research/insight angles (highlighted in blue in the HTML/PDF). Each ~25-30 sec spoken (about 65-75 words). Each focuses on *what we learn about Jehovah/Jesus* and *how to use it in our ministry*. Anchored to scriptures actually cited in the assigned material.

#	Section	Verse anchor	What I take away
L-1	Letter	Rev 2:10	Jesus does not hide coming tests, but he tells us not to be afraid
L-2	Letter	Heb 10:39	Courage means refusing to shrink back
L-3	Letter	Jas 3:17	Courage may start with being willing to make adjustments
L-4	Letter	Heb 11:32-34	Courage is not theory; it has always been lived by real people
I-1	Intro	Matt 26:46	Jesus walked toward danger because love moved him
I-2	Intro	Matt 26:41	Jesus is courageous and reasonable with weak humans
I-3	Intro	John 16:33	Jesus tells frightened followers: “Take courage”
I-4	Intro	Heb 13:5, 6	Courage grows when Jehovah’s help becomes real to us
R1	Intro	Matt 26:36-46	 <i>Jesus book:</i> Gethsemane shows courage under emotional pressure
R2	Letter	Rev 2:10	 <i>Insight book:</i> Smyrna was real, and Jesus’ counsel still reaches us

A Letter From the Governing Body

Comment L-1 — Jesus prepares us, not frightens us

Revelation 2:10

What stands out to me from Rev 2:10 is that Jesus did not pretend his followers would avoid suffering. He told them plainly that tests were coming, but he also said not to be afraid. That balance is loving. In the ministry, we do the same. We do not promise people an easy road. We help them see that with Jehovah and Jesus, they can face the road.

Comment L-2 — Do not shrink back

Hebrews 10:39

Heb 10:39 gives courage a very practical definition: refusing to shrink back. Sometimes courage is not a dramatic public stand. It is staying where Jehovah put us when fear says, “Step back. Be quiet. Slow down.” The letter reminds us that all of us can choose courage. In the ministry, that helps me encourage timid ones. Courage is a choice Jehovah can strengthen.

Comment L-3 — Courage to make adjustments

James 3:17

The letter mentions making adjustments, and Jas 3:17 helps me see why that takes courage. Wisdom from above is reasonable and ready to obey, but pride resists change. Jonathan showed courage when he accepted Jehovah’s choice of David. That teaches me that courage is not only standing firm against enemies. Sometimes it is humbly changing when Jehovah makes his direction clear.

Comment L-4 — Courage has faces

Hebrews 11:32-34

Heb 11:32-34 reminds me that courage is not just an idea. It has faces: judges, prophets, men and women who were weak at times but became powerful through faith. That is why this new publication can help us. We are not studying perfect heroes at a distance. We are studying imperfect servants Jehovah strengthened. In the ministry, those examples can make courage feel possible.

Introduction — You Can Grow in Courage!

Comment I-1 — “Get up, let us go”

Matthew 26:46

Matt 26:46 is powerful because Jesus knew exactly what was coming. He was not walking into danger blindly. He understood the cost, and still said, “Let us go.” That was courage guided by love for his Father and for us. It makes me ask: when obedience feels costly, do I move toward Jehovah’s will, or do I look for a way around it?

Comment I-2 — Courage with compassion

Matthew 26:41

Matt 26:41 helps me love Jesus even more. On the hardest night of his human life, his apostles disappointed him by falling asleep. But he did not crush them. He said the spirit was eager, but the flesh was weak. That tells me courageous people do not have to be harsh. Jesus was the bravest man alive, and still deeply reasonable with weak humans.

Comment I-3 — “Take courage”

John 16:33

John 16:33 is not just a command; it is reassurance from someone who has already won. Jesus says to take courage because he has conquered the world. That means our courage is not based on our personality. It is based on our King. In the ministry, this is encouraging for people who say, “I’m not brave.” Christian courage can be borrowed from confidence in Christ.

Comment I-4 — Jehovah is my helper

Hebrews 13:5, 6

Heb 13:5, 6 shows how courage grows. First Jehovah says, “I will never leave you.” Then we can say, “Jehovah is my helper.” So courage begins by listening to what Jehovah says about himself. If I really believe he is present and helping, fear loses some of its authority. In the ministry, we help people build that same confidence in Jehovah.



Research angle · Intro — Gethsemane pressure

Matthew 26:36-46

The *Jesus–The Way* account helps us picture the setting in Gethsemane. Jesus was deeply grieved, praying intensely, and waiting for enemies he knew were coming. That makes Matt 26:46 even stronger. Courage is not the absence of emotional pain. Jesus felt the pressure fully, prayed through it, and then moved forward. That is the pattern when our own courage is low.



Revelation 2:10

The *Insight* material on the congregations of Revelation notes that Smyrna was a real place, and early Christians there were urged not to be afraid even though some would face prison. I like that because Jesus' counsel was not abstract. It reached real brothers and sisters under real pressure. The same King gives real courage to real Christians today.